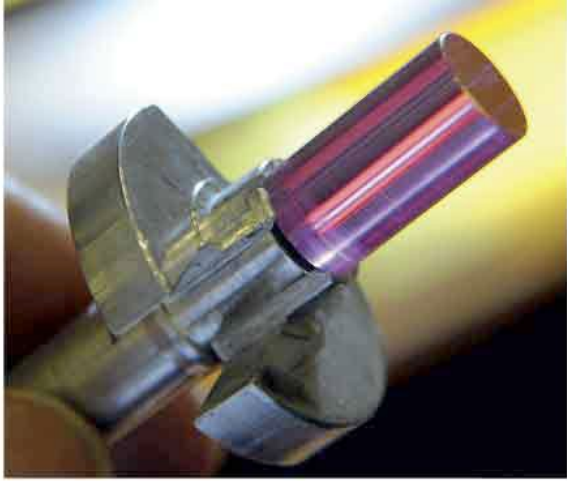
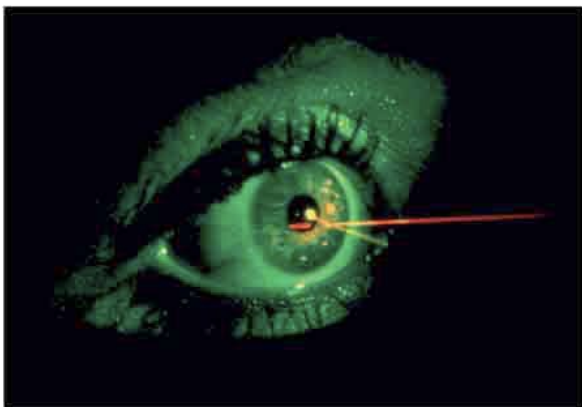
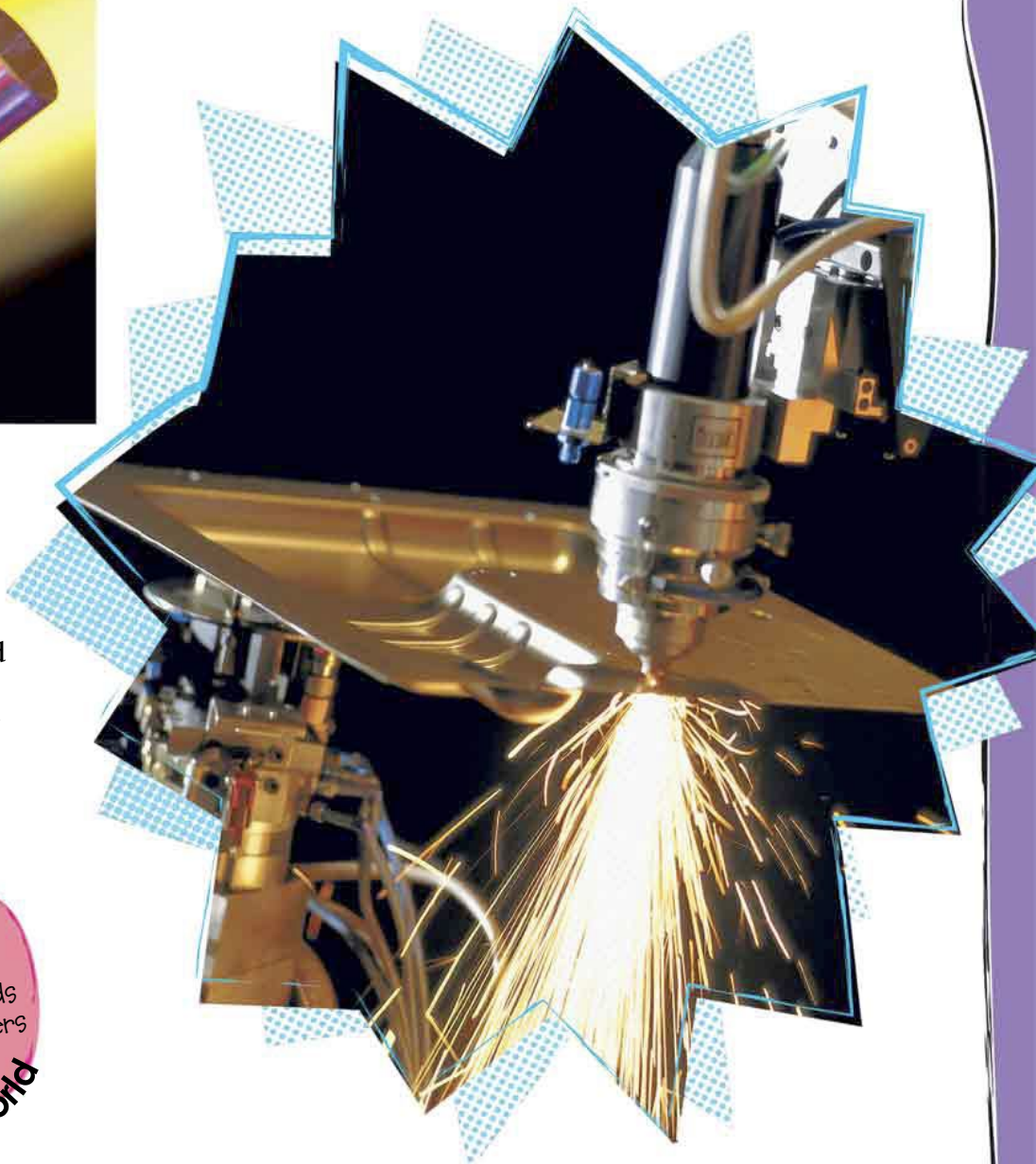




First laser

The first working laser was produced in 1960. A ruby crystal rod (above) was placed inside a photographer's flash bulb. When the atoms in the rod were excited by the light from the flash, they generated energy as an intense pulse of red light. The ruby laser was a research tool, without a practical use.

How it changed the world
In addition to their use in industry and surgery, lasers are used in all kinds of objects, from CD players to laser printers.



Laser surgery

Lasers also perform *valuable medical work*. They can weld a detached retina back into place and correct myopia (shortsightedness). They can also seal blood vessels and act as a **highly accurate scalpel**, destroying harmful or diseased cells with precision.

Cutting-edge technology

Today, many different kinds of lasers are produced to perform *dozens of different tasks*. **INDUSTRIAL LASERS** wielded by robots (above) can be focused tightly on a single spot to drill holes or **cut through thick metal** and other tough materials accurately. Some lasers are used to weld metals together or to etch electronic circuits.

Laser

The instrument that focuses BEAMS OF LIGHT to perform amazing medical and industrial tasks